

CYBERSECURITY MANAGEMENT PROJECT PROPOSAL BUDGET PLAN

Enterprise Security Infrastructure Initiative -- FY 2027

I. Executive Summary

This budget covers everything needed to build a solid cybersecurity program for a mid-sized organization. It includes network security, endpoint protection, identity management, cloud infrastructure, physical security, compliance tools, and the staff to run it all. The total comes in under the \$2 million cap.

The initial project cost with tax is \$1,858,923.00. After the first year, recurring costs run about \$383,200.00 per year. Everything in this plan is built to last at least 3 to 5 years, so the investment pays off over time.

Grand Total (with Tax)	Year 1 Recurring Costs	5-Yr TCO / User
\$1,858,923.00	\$383,200.00	~\$16,959.00

II. Budget Categories Overview

The budget is split into eight main areas. Each one covers a different part of the security plan.

- Network Security Infrastructure -- Firewall, IDS/IPS, SIEM, and network segmentation
- Endpoint Protection -- EDR/XDR platform, workstations, laptops, and managed antivirus
- Identity and Access Management (IAM) -- MFA, privileged access management, and SSO
- Cloud Infrastructure and Security -- Secure cloud hosting, CASB, and backup/recovery services
- Physical Security -- Access control, surveillance cameras, and environmental monitoring
- Compliance and Risk Management -- Vulnerability management, GRC tools, and audit services

- Personnel and Training -- Cybersecurity team salaries, certifications, and awareness training
- Telecommunications and Connectivity -- Internet services, VoIP, and secure remote access

III. Detailed Itemized Budget

Category	Item / Description	Unit Cost	Qty	Initial Cost	Monthly Recur.	Annual Recur.
1. NETWORK SECURITY INFRASTRUCTURE						
Network Security	Palo Alto PA-5220 Next-Gen Firewall (HA pair)	\$28,000	2	\$56,000	N/A	\$5,600
Network Security	Cisco Catalyst 9300 Layer 3 Switch (core)	\$12,500	2	\$25,000	N/A	N/A
Network Security	Cisco Catalyst 9200 Layer 2 Access Switch	\$4,800	6	\$28,800	N/A	N/A
Network Security	Cisco Meraki MR57 Wi-Fi 6E Access Points	\$2,100	12	\$25,200	N/A	\$4,320
Network Security	Splunk Enterprise SIEM (250 GB/day ingest)	\$72,000/yr	1	\$72,000	\$6,000	\$72,000
Network Security	Cisco SmartNet 24x7 Support (all switches)	\$1,000/dev/yr	8	N/A	N/A	\$8,000
Network Security	Cat6a Plenum cabling and installation labor	\$18,500	1	\$18,500	N/A	N/A
Network Security Subtotal				\$225,500	\$6,000/mo	\$89,920/yr
2. ENDPOINT PROTECTION						
Endpoint	Huntress Managed EDR (24x7 SOC, 200 endpoints)	\$7/ep/mo	200	N/A	\$1,400	\$16,800
Endpoint	Dell Latitude 5550 Laptops (i7, 16GB RAM, 512GB SSD)	\$1,450	75	\$108,750	N/A	N/A
Endpoint	Dell OptiPlex 7010 Desktops (i7, 16GB, 512GB)	\$1,100	50	\$55,000	N/A	N/A
Endpoint	Dell PowerEdge R750 Servers (16-core, 128GB RAM)	\$14,000	4	\$56,000	N/A	N/A
Endpoint	Dell 5-yr ProSupport Plus (laptops and desktops)	\$250/dev	125	\$31,250	N/A	N/A
Endpoint Protection Subtotal				\$251,000	\$1,400/mo	\$16,800/yr
3. IDENTITY AND ACCESS MANAGEMENT (IAM)						

Category	Item / Description	Unit Cost	Qty	Initial Cost	Monthly Recur.	Annual Recur.
IAM	Okta Workforce Identity Cloud (SSO and MFA, 200 users)	\$18/user/mo	200	N/A	\$3,600	\$43,200
IAM	CyberArk Privileged Access Manager (PAM, 50 accounts)	\$35,000/yr	1	\$35,000	\$2,917	\$35,000
IAM	YubiKey 5 NFC Hardware Tokens (FIDO2 MFA)	\$55	200	\$11,000	N/A	N/A
IAM Subtotal				\$46,000	\$6,517/mo	\$78,200/yr
4. CLOUD INFRASTRUCTURE AND SECURITY						
Cloud	Microsoft Azure (commercial, US regions, compute and storage, 500TB)	\$8,000/mo	1	\$4,000 (50% dn)	\$8,000	\$96,000
Cloud	Microsoft Defender for Cloud (CSPM/CWPP)	\$15/node/mo	100	N/A	\$1,500	\$18,000
Cloud	Veeam Backup and Replication (Enterprise Plus)	\$22,000/yr	1	\$22,000	\$1,833	\$22,000
Cloud	Microsoft 365 E5 Security (200 users, includes Entra ID)	\$57/user/mo	200	N/A	\$11,400	\$136,800
Cloud Infrastructure Subtotal				\$26,000	\$22,733/mo	\$272,800/yr
5. PHYSICAL SECURITY						
Physical	Verkada CD62 IP Security Cameras (4K, PoE)	\$1,200	24	\$28,800	N/A	\$5,760
Physical	Verkada Access Control (card readers and door controllers)	\$850	16	\$13,600	N/A	\$3,200
Physical	HID Global Proximity Cards (500 pack)	\$1,850	2	\$3,700	N/A	N/A
Physical	Biometric fingerprint safes (server room)	\$600	4	\$2,400	N/A	N/A
Physical	Eaton 9PX 10kVA UPS (rack-mounted, data center)	\$6,500	2	\$13,000	N/A	N/A
Physical Security Subtotal				\$61,500	N/A	\$8,960/yr
6. COMPLIANCE AND RISK MANAGEMENT						

Category	Item / Description	Unit Cost	Qty	Initial Cost	Monthly Recur.	Annual Recur.
Compliance	Qualys VMDB (vulnerability management, 500 assets)	\$28,000/yr	1	\$28,000	\$2,333	\$28,000
Compliance	Archer GRC Platform (risk, audit, and compliance management)	\$40,000/yr	1	\$40,000	\$3,333	\$40,000
Compliance	Penetration Testing (annual third-party engagement)	\$25,000	1	\$25,000	N/A	\$25,000
Compliance and Risk Subtotal				\$93,000	\$5,666/mo	\$93,000/yr
7. PERSONNEL AND TRAINING						
Personnel	CISO / Security Director (annual salary)	\$185,000	1	\$185,000	\$15,417	\$185,000
Personnel	Senior Network Security Engineer (annual salary)	\$130,000	2	\$260,000	\$21,667	\$260,000
Personnel	Cybersecurity Analyst / SOC Analyst (annual salary)	\$95,000	3	\$285,000	\$23,750	\$285,000
Personnel	IT Systems Administrator (annual salary)	\$85,000	2	\$170,000	\$14,167	\$170,000
Personnel	Security Awareness Training (KnowBe4, 200 users)	\$18,000/yr	1	\$18,000	\$1,500	\$18,000
Personnel	Professional Certifications (CISSP, CEH, CompTIA budget)	\$5,000/person	8	\$40,000	N/A	\$20,000
Personnel and Training Subtotal				\$958,000	\$76,501/mo	\$918,000/yr
8. TELECOMMUNICATIONS AND CONNECTIVITY						
Telecom	AT&T Business Fiber -- 10 Gbps dedicated internet	\$950/mo	1	\$950 (install)	\$950	\$11,400
Telecom	Zscaler Zero Trust Exchange (ZIA and ZPA, 200 users)	\$50/user/yr	200	\$10,000	\$833	\$10,000
Telecom	GoDaddy SSL Wildcard Certificate and Domain Security	\$570	1	\$570	N/A	\$570
Telecom	Cisco IP Phones 8841 and 8831 Conference Phones	\$515 to \$1,495	32	\$18,580	N/A	N/A
Telecom and Connectivity Subtotal				\$30,100	\$1,783/mo	\$21,970/yr

Category	Item / Description	Unit Cost	Qty	Initial Cost	Monthly Recur.	Annual Recur.
9. PROFESSIONAL SERVICES AND IMPLEMENTATION						
Prof. Services	Network Architecture and Engineering (15 days)	\$3,500/day	15	\$52,500	N/A	N/A
Prof. Services	Security Policy and Documentation Development	\$12,000	1	\$12,000	N/A	N/A
Prof. Services	Hardware Installation and Rack Configuration (5 days)	\$2,200/day	5	\$11,000	N/A	N/A
Prof. Services	Project Management (full project lifecycle)	\$25,000	1	\$25,000	N/A	N/A
Professional Services Subtotal				\$100,500	N/A	N/A
Contingency Reserve (5% of equipment and services)				\$25,750	N/A	N/A
PROJECT SUBTOTAL (pre-tax)				\$1,717,250	\$118,400/mo	\$383,200/yr

IV. Grand Total and Financing

Here is the complete cost breakdown with Texas sales tax and the payment schedule.

Financial Summary	Amount
Project Initial Subtotal (hardware, software, services, and Year 1 personnel)	\$1,717,250.00
Estimated Sales Tax (8.25% combined Texas state and local rate, Dallas)	\$141,673.00
GRAND TOTAL (with Tax)	\$1,858,923.00
40% Down Payment (required to start the project)	\$743,569.00
Remaining Balance (due after project completion and user acceptance)	\$1,115,354.00
Year 2 and beyond -- Annual Recurring Costs	\$383,200.00/yr

V. Total Cost of Ownership (TCO) Analysis

TCO is based on the 5-year lifespan of the main hardware assets like servers and network equipment. It is divided across 200 supported user endpoints.

TCO Formula: $TCO = [\text{Grand Total} + (\text{Annual Recurring} \times 4)]$ divided by 200 users divided by 5 years

$TCO = [\$1,858,923 + (\$383,200 \times 4)]$ divided by 200 divided by 5

$TCO = [\$1,858,923 + \$1,532,800]$ divided by 1,000

$TCO = \$3,391,723$ divided by 1,000 user-years = \$3,391.72 per user per year (or ~\$16,959 per user over the full 5-year period)

That comes out to about \$3,392 per user per year, or roughly \$16,959 per user over the full 5-year period. For a mid-sized organization, that is a reasonable number. According to the IBM Cost of a Data Breach Report 2025, the U.S. average breach cost has reached over \$10 million, while the global average sits at \$4.4 million. One prevented breach more than pays for this entire plan.

VI. Budget Justifications

6.1 Network Security Infrastructure

Palo Alto Networks was chosen over Fortinet and Check Point because it has better threat intelligence and more detailed traffic inspection. Running two firewalls in a high-availability pair means there is no single point of failure. If one goes down, the other takes over. The Splunk SIEM pulls logs from every part of the network so the team can catch threats quickly. This also meets the NIST SP 800-137 requirements for continuous monitoring.

6.2 Endpoint Protection

Endpoint protection uses a layered approach. Microsoft Defender for Endpoint Plan 2 is included with the Microsoft 365 E5 license already purchased for the user base, providing native EDR, attack surface reduction, automated investigation, and tight integration with Entra ID, Intune, and the rest of the Microsoft security stack at no incremental cost. Huntress Managed EDR sits on top of Defender as a force multiplier: their 24x7 SOC reviews telemetry, triages alerts, and responds to incidents around the clock, which closes the after-hours coverage gap without requiring the in-house SOC to staff overnight shifts. This pairing is significantly more cost-effective than a single premium MDR product while delivering equivalent or better detection and response outcomes for an organization of this size. Dell laptops and desktops were selected because they come with a 5-year ProSupport Plus warranty and integrate cleanly with Microsoft Intune and Endpoint Manager, keeping management simple and replacement costs predictable.

6.3 Identity and Access Management

Okta was chosen over Microsoft Entra ID because it works across both cloud apps and on-premises systems without being tied to one vendor. CyberArk handles privileged accounts, which is one of the most common ways attackers move through a network once they get in. YubiKey hardware tokens eliminate phishing for admin accounts because the key has to be physically present to log in.

6.4 Cloud Infrastructure

Commercial Microsoft Azure (US regions) was selected for cost efficiency, broad service availability, and data residency within U.S. boundaries; Azure Government would only be appropriate if the organization handles federal CUI or holds applicable government contracts. Microsoft 365 E5 is the cornerstone of the security stack because a single license bundles Microsoft Defender for Endpoint Plan 2, Defender for Office 365 Plan 2, Defender for Identity, Defender for Cloud Apps, Entra ID P2, Purview compliance and DLP, and Insider Risk Management. Consolidating into E5 cuts down on separate vendor contracts and provides native EDR (paired with Huntress Managed EDR for 24x7 SOC coverage, see Section 6.2). Veeam backs up everything, both in the cloud and on-site, so recovery is covered no matter what happens.

6.5 Personnel

Personnel is the biggest part of the budget and that is on purpose. Technology alone does not stop attacks. You need trained people watching the systems and responding when something goes wrong. Salaries are based on 2024 SANS Salary Survey data and BLS figures for the Dallas area. The plan includes a CISO for security leadership, two engineers for the network and systems, three SOC analysts for around-the-clock coverage, and two administrators to keep everything running. Certification budgets are included so the team stays current on threats and qualifications.

VII. Return on Investment (ROI) and Risk Reduction

Here is why this investment makes sense financially.

- Breach Cost Avoidance: According to the IBM Cost of a Data Breach Report 2025, the U.S. average breach cost is over \$10 million, with the global average at \$4.4 million. Preventing even one breach over five years puts us well ahead on this \$1.86 million investment.
- Downtime Reduction: The high-availability network design keeps systems up even during failures. At \$10,000 per hour of downtime, avoiding 10 outages a year saves \$100,000 annually.
- Regulatory Compliance: Staying aligned with NIST CSF, CMMC, and PCI DSS avoids fines that can run anywhere from \$150,000 to \$4.5 million per violation.
- Insurance Savings: Organizations with strong controls like EDR, MFA, and a SIEM typically see 15 to 25 percent reductions in cyber insurance premiums.
- Productivity Gains: Single sign-on and unified identity management saves employees about 30 minutes per week in login and password-reset time. Across 200 users at a fully loaded average labor cost of roughly \$50 per hour, that adds up to approximately \$260,000 in recovered productivity per year.

Appendix A -- Vendor Comparison Summary

The table below shows what vendors were considered and why the selections were made.

Category	Selected Vendor	Alternatives Considered	Why I Picked It
NGFW	Palo Alto PA-5220	Fortinet FG-1100E, Check Point 6200	Better threat intelligence and app-level inspection

Category	Selected Vendor	Alternatives Considered	Why I Picked It
EDR/MDR	MS Defender for Endpoint P2 (via E5) + Huntress Managed EDR	CrowdStrike Falcon Complete, SentinelOne Vigilance	Defender P2 included in E5 at no extra cost; Huntress adds 24x7 SOC at a fraction of premium MDR pricing
SIEM	Splunk Enterprise	Microsoft Sentinel, IBM QRadar	Most mature query language and broadest integrations
IAM/SSO	Okta Workforce	Microsoft Entra ID, Ping Identity	Vendor-neutral with strong adaptive MFA options
PAM	CyberArk PAM	BeyondTrust, Delinea	Best option for mixed on-premises and cloud environments
Cloud Security	MS Defender for Cloud	Prisma Cloud, Lacework	Native Azure integration and included in the M365 E5 license
Backup/DR	Veeam Enterprise Plus	Commvault, Zerto	Widest platform support and strong agentless backup
Vuln. Management	Qualys VMDR	Tenable.sc, Rapid7 InsightVM	SaaS delivery with CIS benchmark checks built in

Appendix B -- Salary and Staffing Reference Data

All salary figures come from the SANS 2024 Cybersecurity Salary Survey, Bureau of Labor Statistics data from May 2024, and Glassdoor market data for the Dallas, TX area. Benefits like health insurance, retirement contributions, and FICA add roughly 30 percent on top of base salary. That is not included in the numbers above, but it should be factored into total headcount planning.

Appendix C -- Regulatory Compliance Mapping

This plan was built to cover the following compliance frameworks.

- NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) 2.0 -- All six core functions are covered: Govern, Identify, Protect, Detect, Respond, and Recover
- NIST SP 800-53 Rev. 5 -- Controls mapped to Access Control (AC), Audit and Accountability (AU), Incident Response (IR), and System Protection (SC)
- CIS Controls v8 -- Implementation Group 2 controls fully addressed by the technology stack in this proposal
- CMMC Level 2 -- The 110 practices from NIST SP 800-171 are addressed through EDR, MFA, encryption, and logging
- Texas Data Privacy and Security Act (TDPSA) -- Data handling and breach notification requirements are met through encryption, access controls, and the incident response plan

END OF CYBERSECURITY BUDGET PROPOSAL

All pricing reflects current market data (2025).